

Take-home Assessment: UX Designer II

You're interviewing for the UX Designer role at Salaria Sales Solutions.

The product is **RemoteRecruit.com**, a global hiring platform that connects employers with talent through video resumes and AI-assisted ranking.

TIME

90–120 minutes total

FORMAT

Async / take-home

PARTS

2 (Audit + Design)

MAX SCORE

40 points

What we're looking for

We're evaluating how you think, not how polished your deliverables look. We want to see you identify real problems in a real product, frame them clearly, and design responses grounded in user needs.

- Specific, product-grounded observations — not generic UX advice
- Clear reasoning behind every design decision
- Awareness of both sides of the marketplace: employers and candidates
- Appropriate fidelity — wireframes are perfectly fine

Use any tools you like (Figma, FigJam, Whimsical, pen and paper). AI tools are allowed, but be ready to discuss your decisions in the follow-up interview.

Candidate Name: **Alyssa Rhenoa Nicole D. Bautista**

Location: Philippines

Profile: Currently working with **3+ years of experience as a hybrid UI/UX Engineer and Frontend Developer**.

Along with my **5+ years of relevant experience in Design**. My role spans frontend engineering, design systems, multimedia production, and cross-team collaboration.

Part 1: Heuristic Audit

Suggested time: 30 min. Before designing, use the product as a real user would.

Visit Remote Recruit using the URL <https://dev.remoterecruit.com/new/> as an employer hiring a UX Designer.

Browse candidates, try the search and filters, open a few profiles.

Task 1: Identify usability issues

Find 3–5 specific friction points in the product today. For each, annotate the friction point as a UX practitioner.

Task 2: Diagnose your top priority

Pick the highest-priority issue from your audit. Write a 3–5 sentence problem statement covering why it is the top priority issue to fix and what impact it has on the business.

Visiting RemoteRecruit's Website



Initial Impressions

The landing page presents a modern and visually engaging experience that immediately communicates RemoteRecruit's core value proposition: connecting employers with talent through video resumes. The design effectively differentiates the platform from traditional job boards by emphasizing candidate visibility and personality alongside professional information.

Candidate Carousel

A prominent candidate carousel showcases available talent on the platform. Each card includes:

- Candidate profile photo
- Country flag and location
- Candidate name
- An estimate of the number of similar professionals available on the platform
- Candidate hourly rate in USD

This presentation helps communicate the platform's global talent pool while providing employers with basic information for initial candidate discovery.

Video Resume Interaction

Hovering over a candidate card automatically plays the candidate's submitted video resume in a muted state. This interaction reinforces Remote Recruit's video-first approach and allows employers to quickly preview a candidate's communication style and presentation.

Candidate Profile Preview

Selecting a candidate from the carousel opens a profile preview modal. The modal provides access to the candidate's video resume and additional profile information, serving as the primary entry point for evaluating candidate qualifications beyond the initial card view.

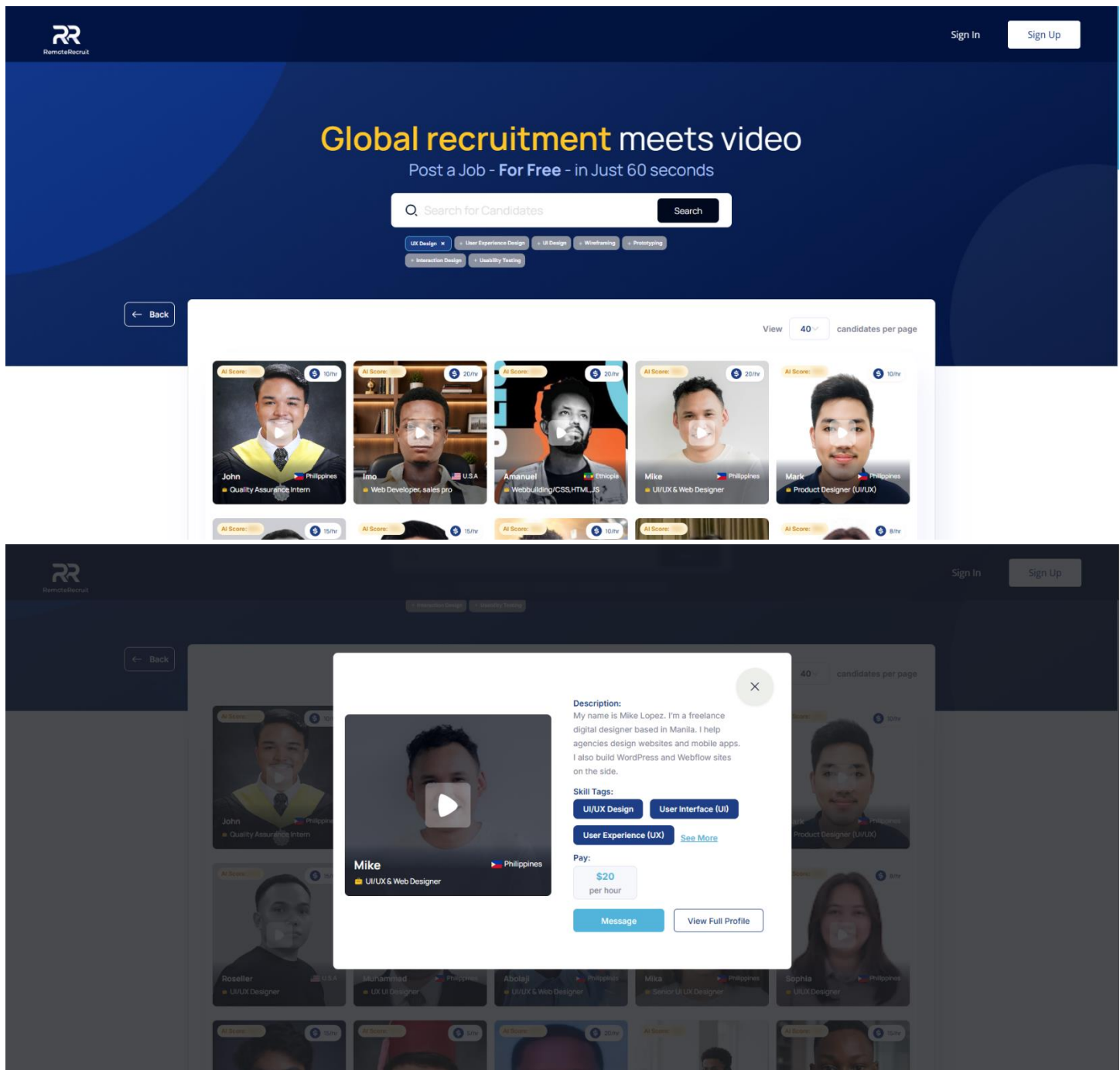
Searching for Candidates

The candidate search bar is prominently positioned near the top center of the landing page, making it one of the primary calls-to-action for employers seeking talent. Directly beneath the search field are several suggested search tags representing popular or in-demand roles.

These suggestion tags act as quick shortcuts, allowing employers to begin browsing candidates without needing to formulate a search query manually. This helps reduce friction for first-time users and provides immediate examples of the types of talent available on the platform.

Upon performing a search, employers are presented with candidate results that can be further explored through candidate cards and profile previews. The search experience serves as the main gateway into the candidate discovery workflow.

Following the assessment instructions, this is my results upon searching for a **UX Design** candidate.

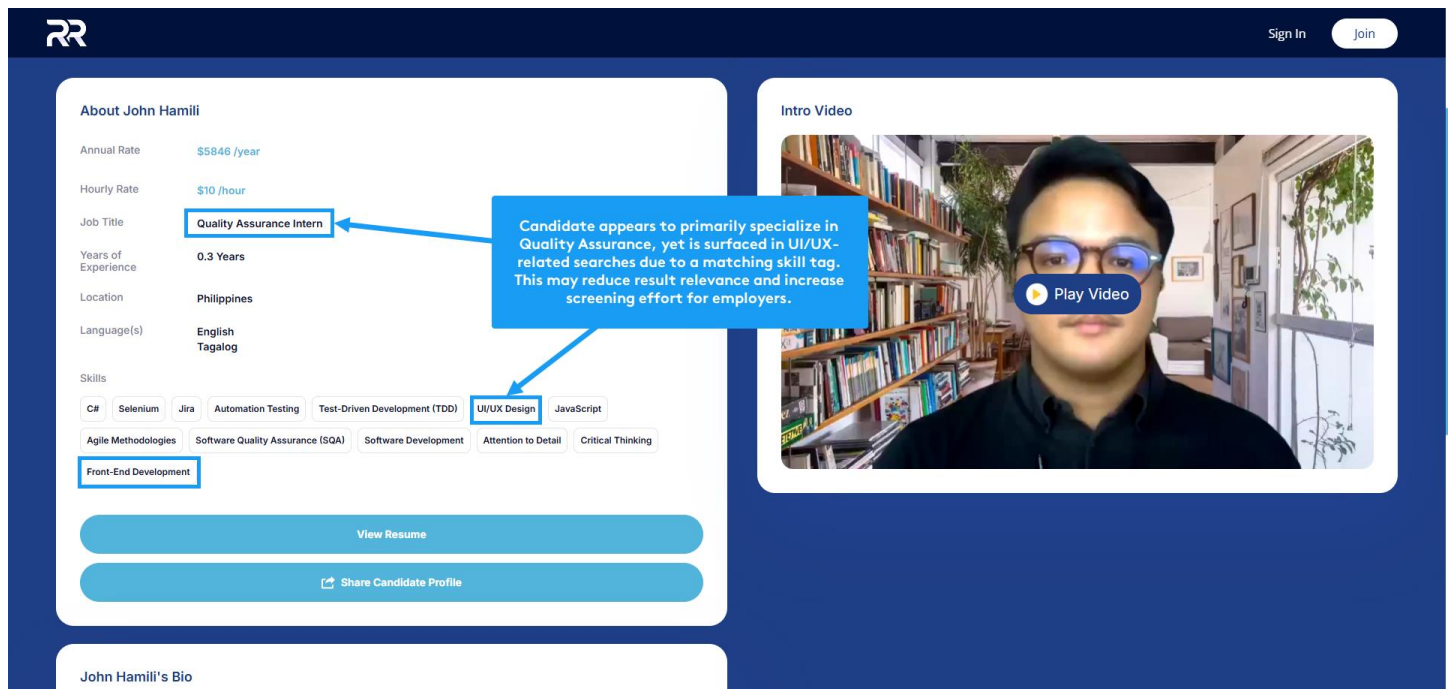
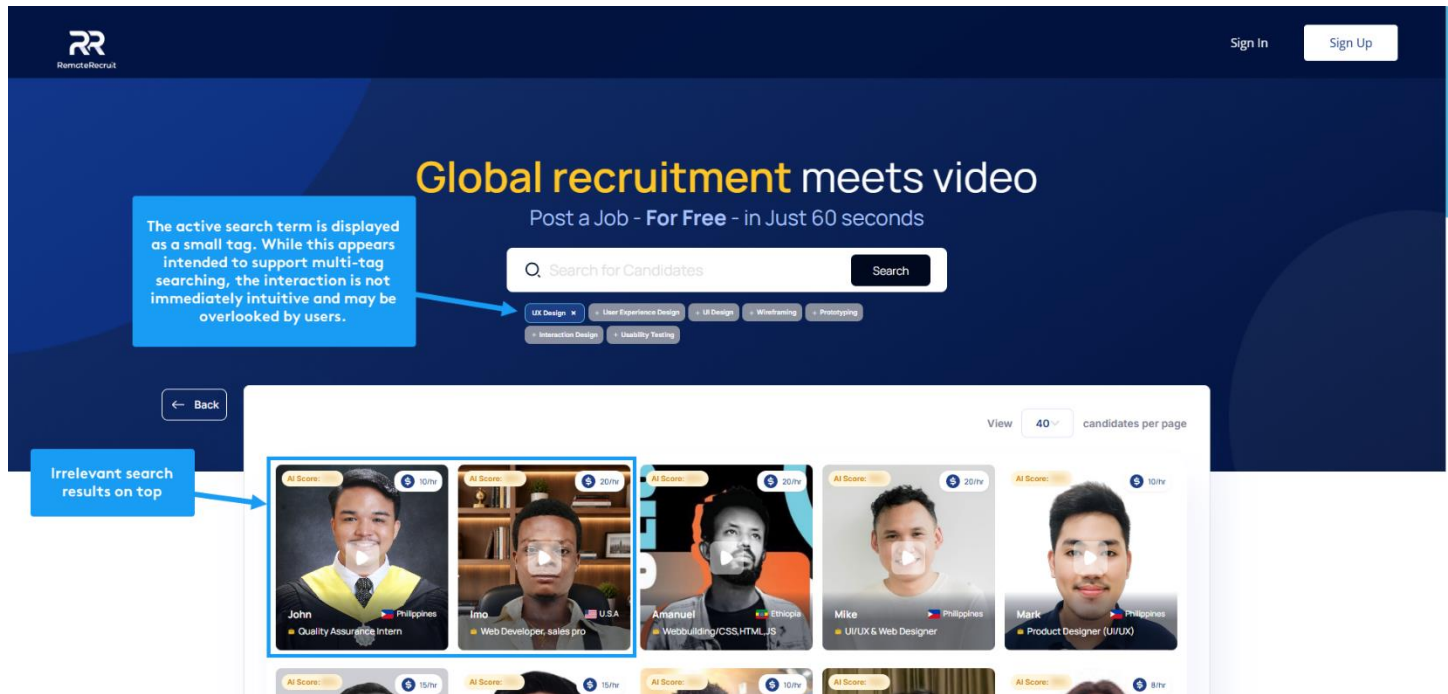


Identifying Usability Issues

With a quick run through the platform, I have identified the following friction points as a UX Practitioner:

1. Limited Candidate Discovery Controls

The search experience provides insufficient filtering options for narrowing candidates based on hiring criteria such as location, time zone, experience level, or other relevant attributes.

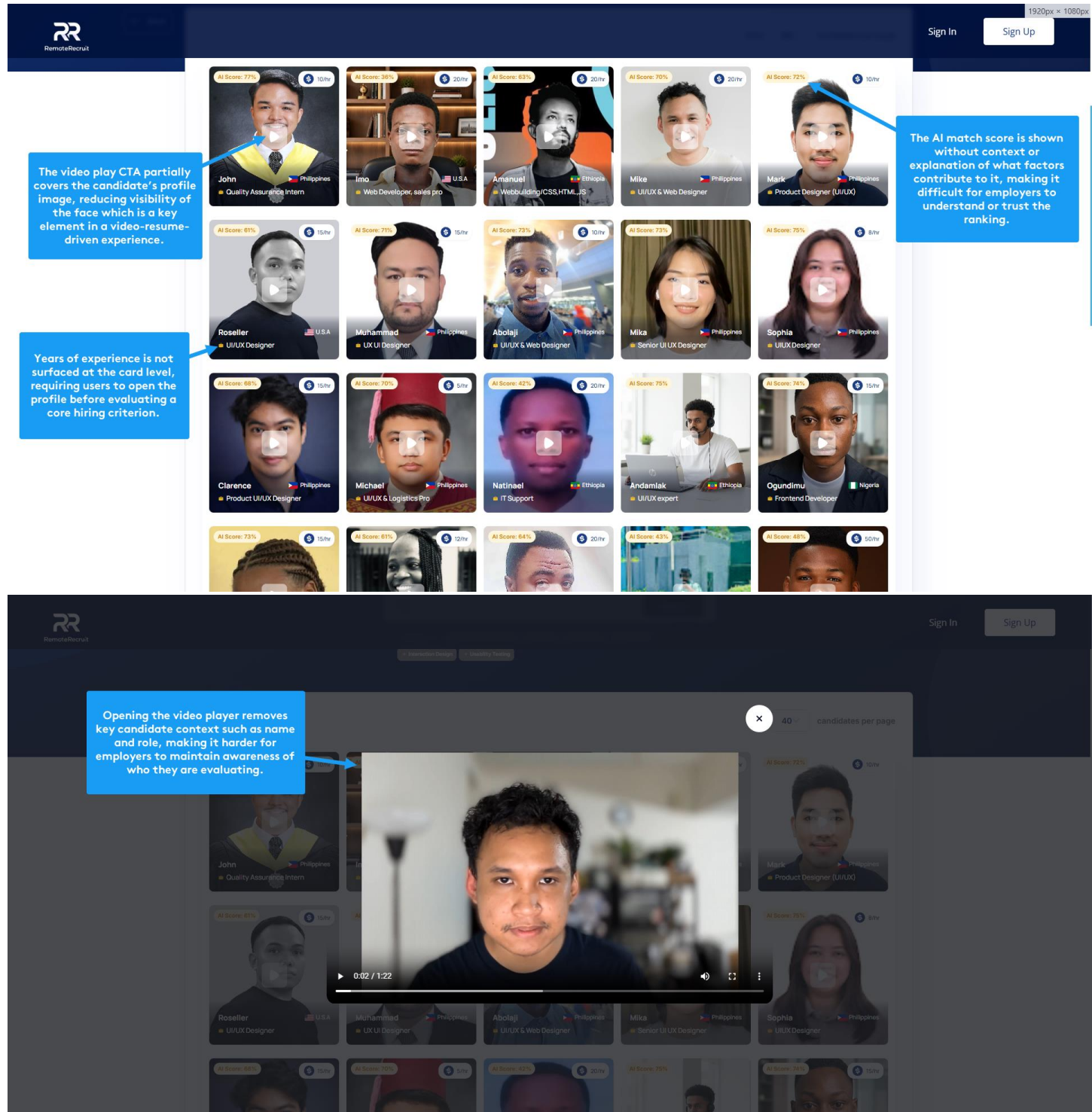


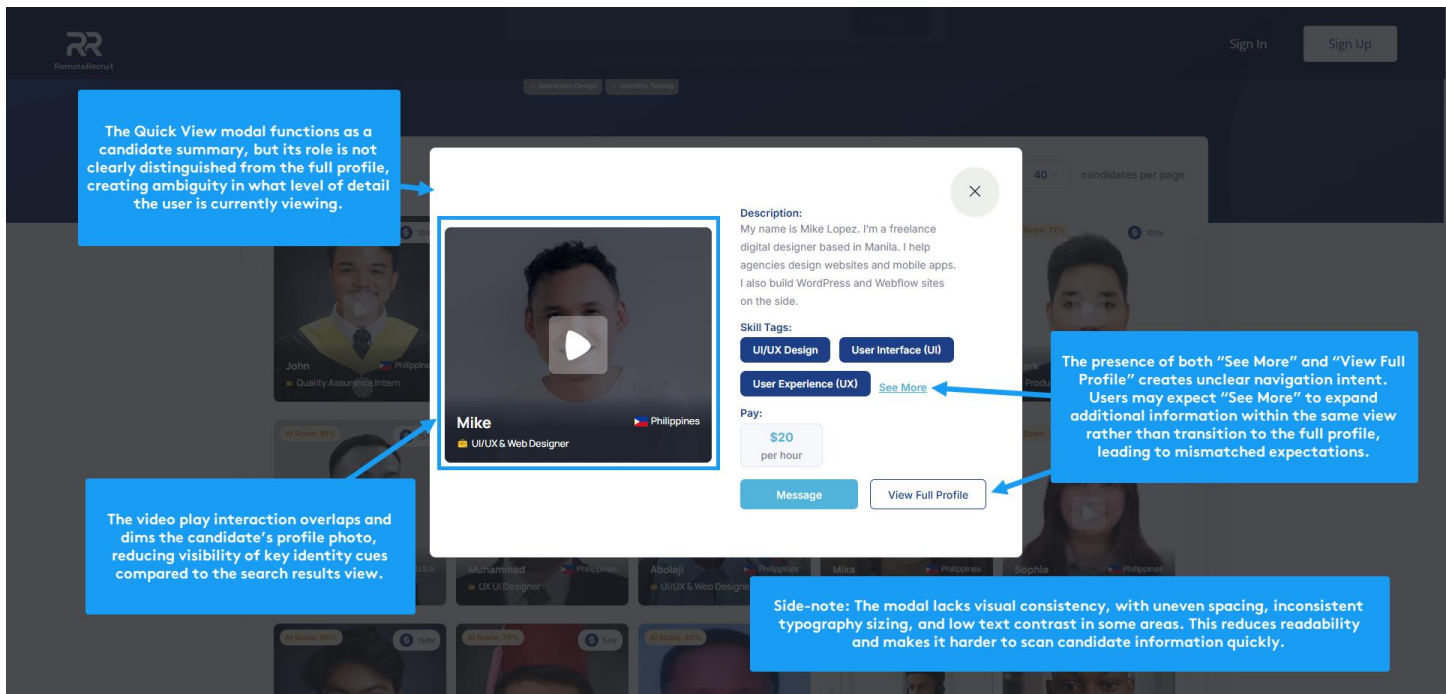
Impact on Employers: Recruiters may spend additional time manually reviewing profiles that are not suitable for their requirements.

Business Impact: Longer screening time reduces the efficiency value proposition of the platform.

2. Candidate Cards Prioritize Visual Content Over Hiring Signals

Candidate cards focus heavily on profile imagery while important screening information such as experience level, work history, availability, or match quality is not immediately visible.

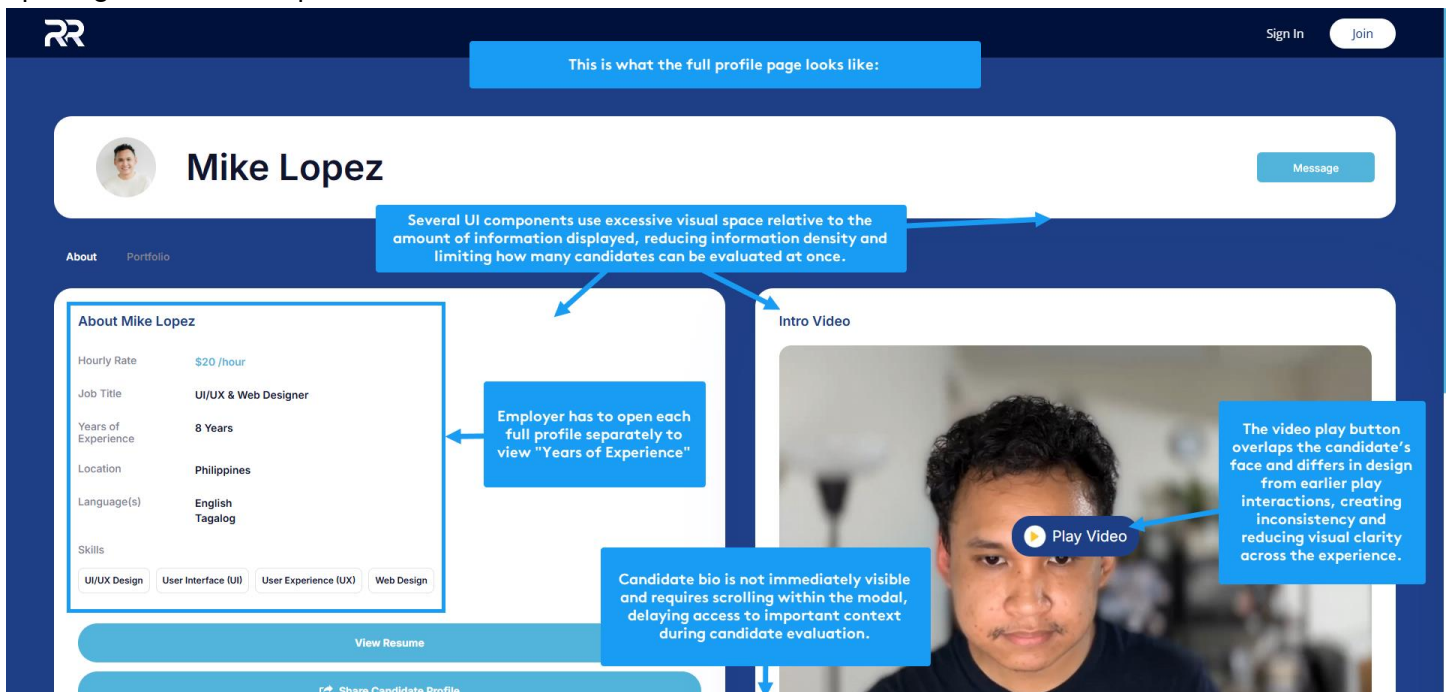


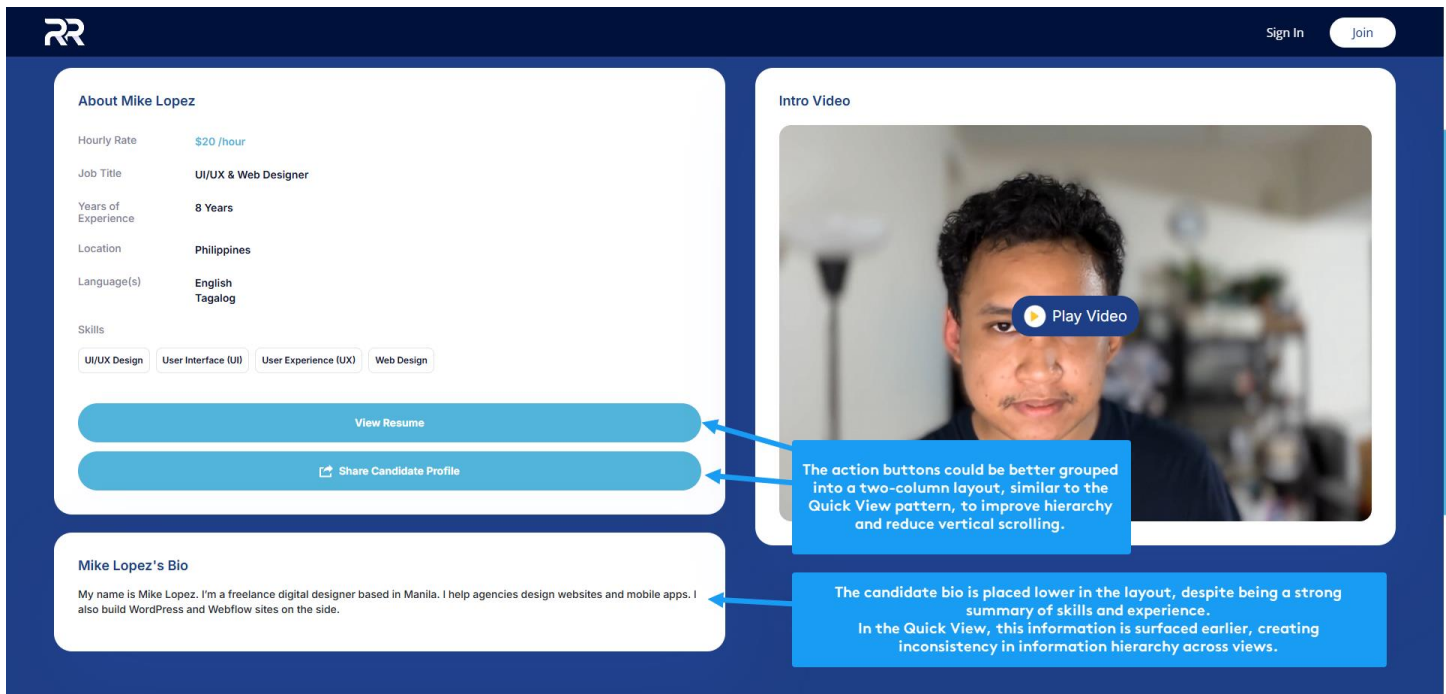


Impact on Employers: Employers cannot quickly determine candidate relevance from browsing results alone.
Business Impact: Increased profile openings and slower candidate evaluation.

3. Work Experience Is Hidden Behind Additional Interactions

Years of experience, a common hiring qualification, are not visible during candidate browsing and require opening the candidate profile.



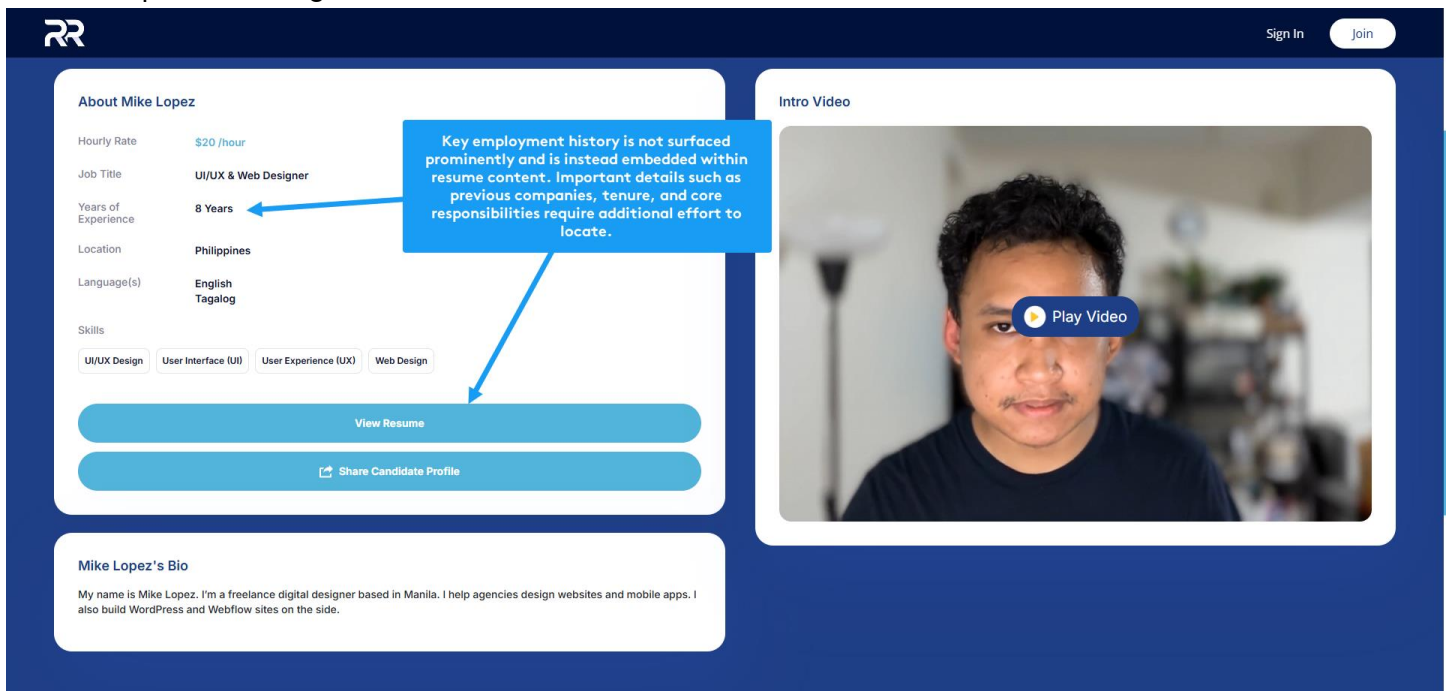


Impact on Employers: Recruiters must perform additional clicks before determining whether a candidate meets minimum experience requirements.

Business Impact: Reduces screening efficiency when reviewing multiple candidates.

4. Employment History Has Low Visibility Within Profiles

Within the candidate profile, previous employers and employment history are not immediately surfaced and instead require reviewing the resume.

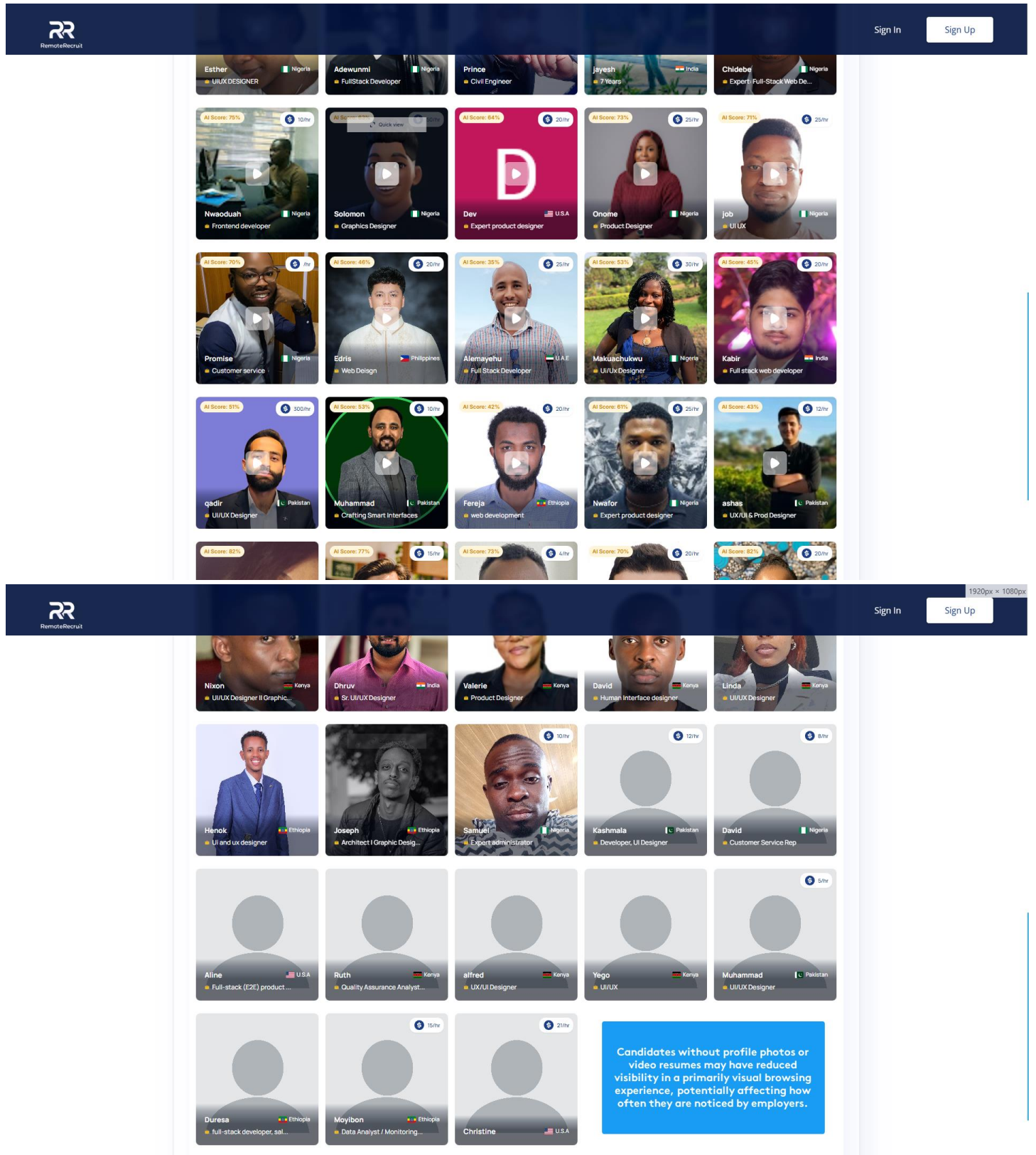


Impact on Employers: Employers may overlook relevant experience or spend additional time searching for critical qualifications.

Business Impact: Increases friction during detailed candidate evaluation.

5. Potential Facial Profiling Bias

The visual-first presentation encourages employers to form impressions based on appearance before reviewing professional qualifications.



Impact on Candidates: Candidates may be judged on visual factors unrelated to job performance.

Business Impact: Can introduce bias into the hiring process and reduce confidence in merit-based candidate evaluation.

Diagnosing my top priority

Friction Point #2: Candidate Cards Prioritize Visual Content Over Hiring Signals

RemoteRecruit's candidate browsing experience emphasizes profile imagery more prominently than the information employers need to make screening decisions. Recruiters often need to assess candidate fit quickly based on qualifications, experience, skills, and work history, yet these details require additional interactions to access. This increases the effort required to evaluate candidates and slows the hiring workflow. As a result, employers may spend more time reviewing profiles while receiving less value from the platform's AI-assisted candidate discovery experience.

Part 2: Design Response

Suggested time: 60–90 mins, any fidelity.

Option A: Candidate card + profile preview

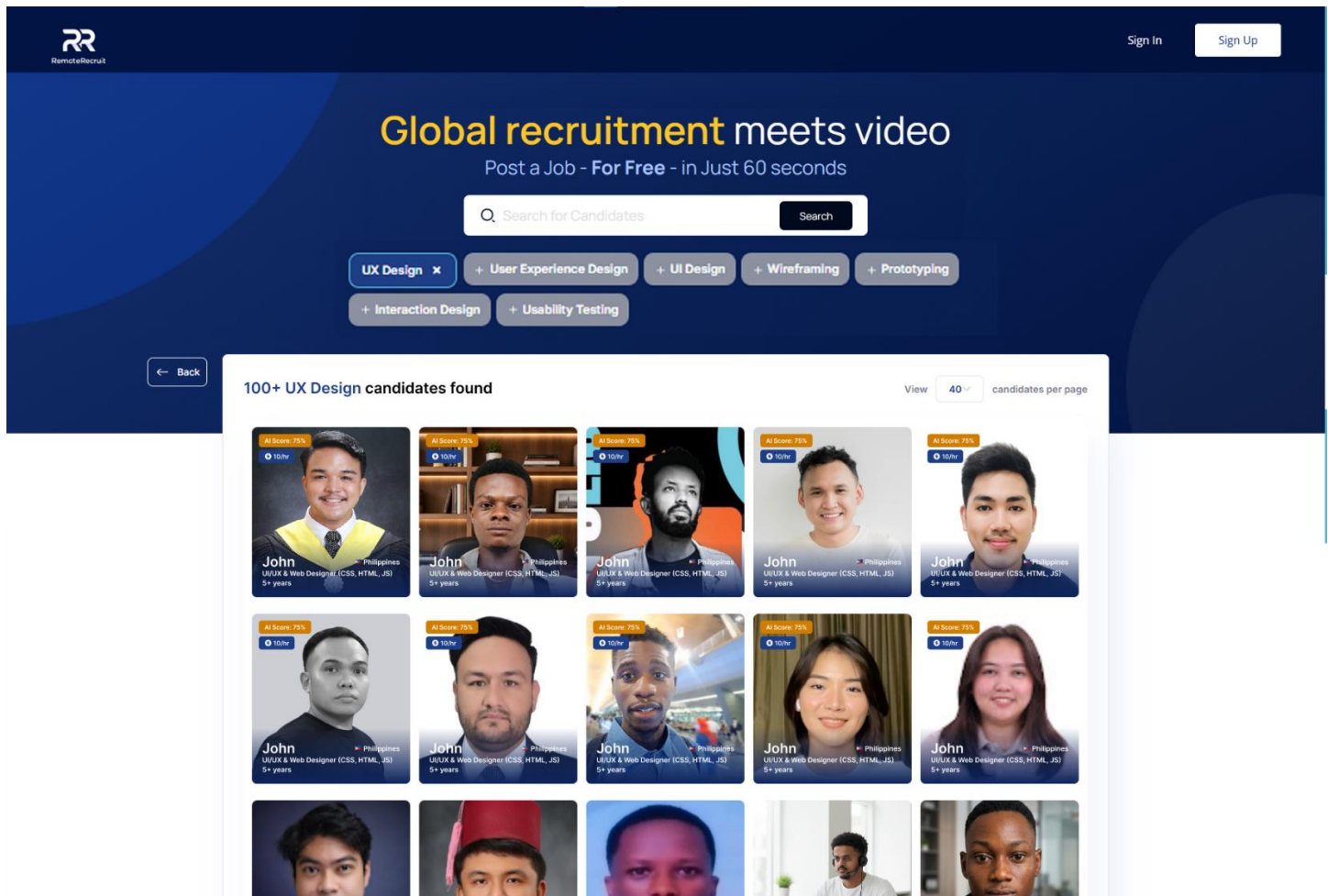
Two connected surfaces in the candidate browsing experience need work:

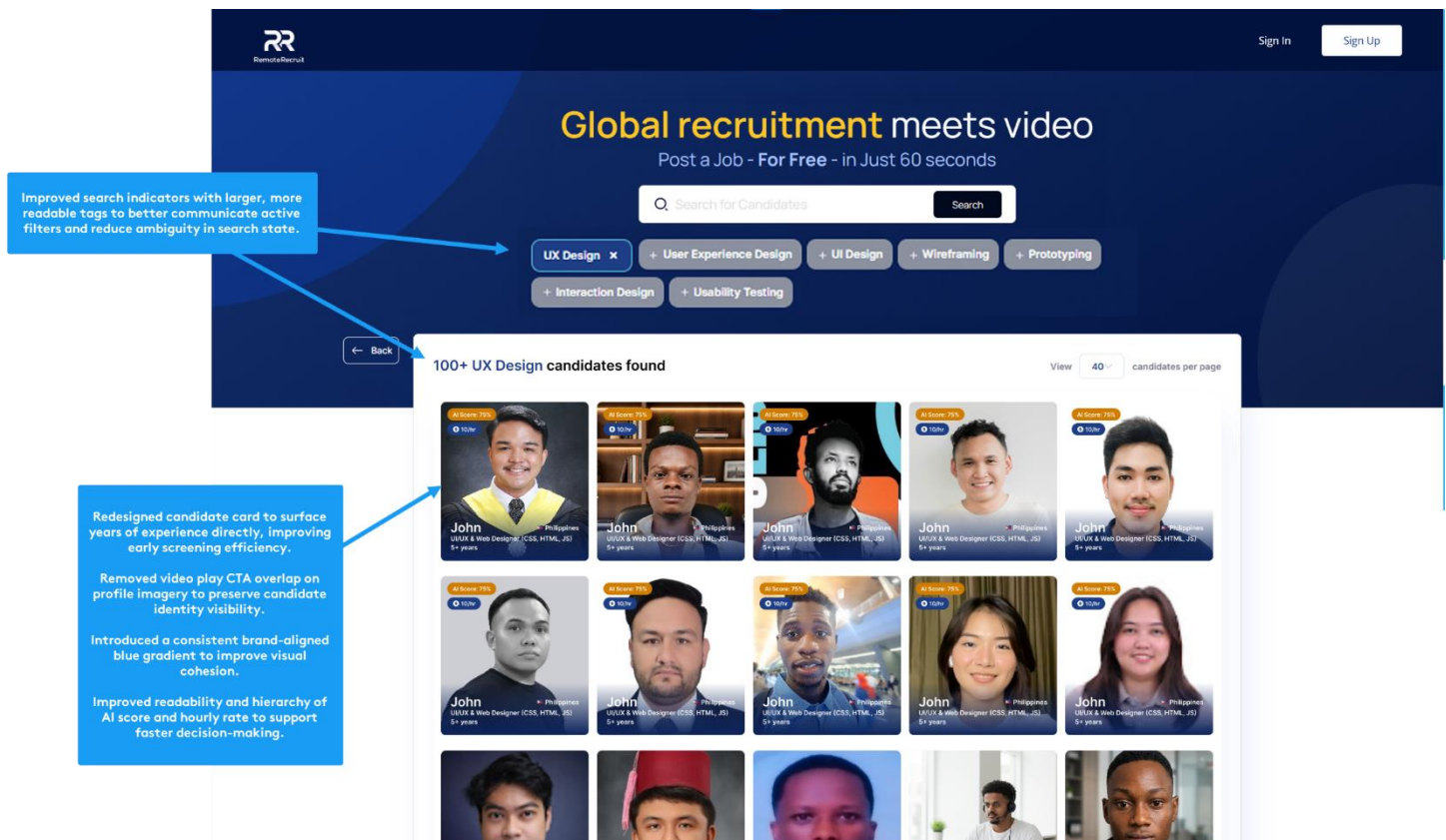
- **The profile card:** photo-first with overlaid name, role, and skill tags.
- **The profile preview modal:** split layout with video resume left, candidate details (name, role, tags, rate, bio, CTAs) right.

Redesign both as a coherent pair.

Annotate your decisions: what changed, why, and what problem each change solves. Focus on hierarchy, information shown, and how the two surfaces connect. Before/after is welcome but not required.

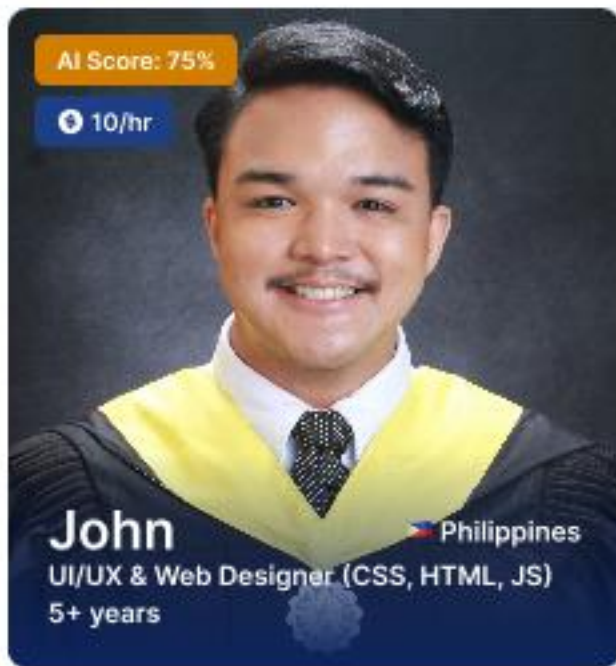
Candidate Profile Card Redesign





Skill tags will be displayed on hover over a candidate card. The "Quick View" button will also be repositioned for better visibility. The goal is to avoid obscuring the candidate's profile photo.

Normal



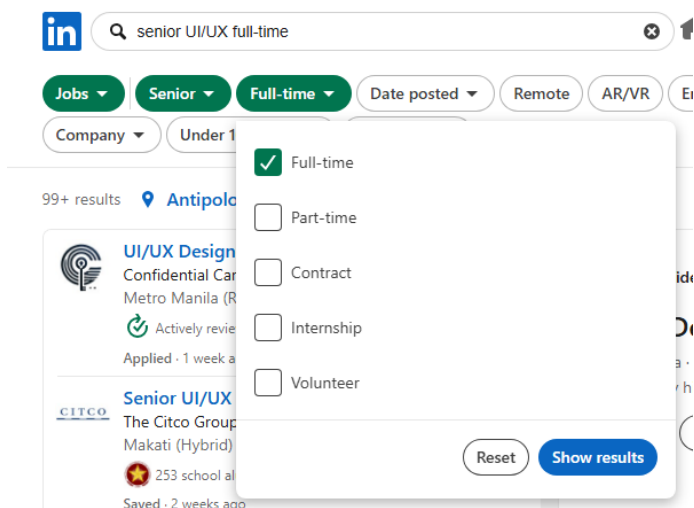
Hovered State



Problem	Changes	Reason
Search indication tags are small	Adjusted the layout of the top section and enlarged the search indicator tags	Improve readability and provide clearer search context
Only indicates “100+ candidates found”	Only indicates “100+ candidates found”	Only indicates “100+ candidates found”
Video play button positioned over profile photos	Removed the video play button; video will now be accessible via the profile preview modal	Ensure the candidate’s face remains visible and unobstructed
AI Score tag has poor text contrast	Updated text color and grouped it with the hourly rate in the top-left position	Improve readability while maintaining alignment with the UI brand colors
Hovering dims the candidate photo and shows “Quick View” button	Removed the dimming effect and repositioned the “Quick View” button to the top-right corner	Preserve photo visibility and avoid overlap with other UI elements
No visible years of experience	Updated layout to display Name, Country, Role, and Years of Experience	Surface key candidate information without requiring full profile access
No visible skill tags	Display skill tags on hover over the card	Allow users to view skills without opening the profile preview modal or full profile

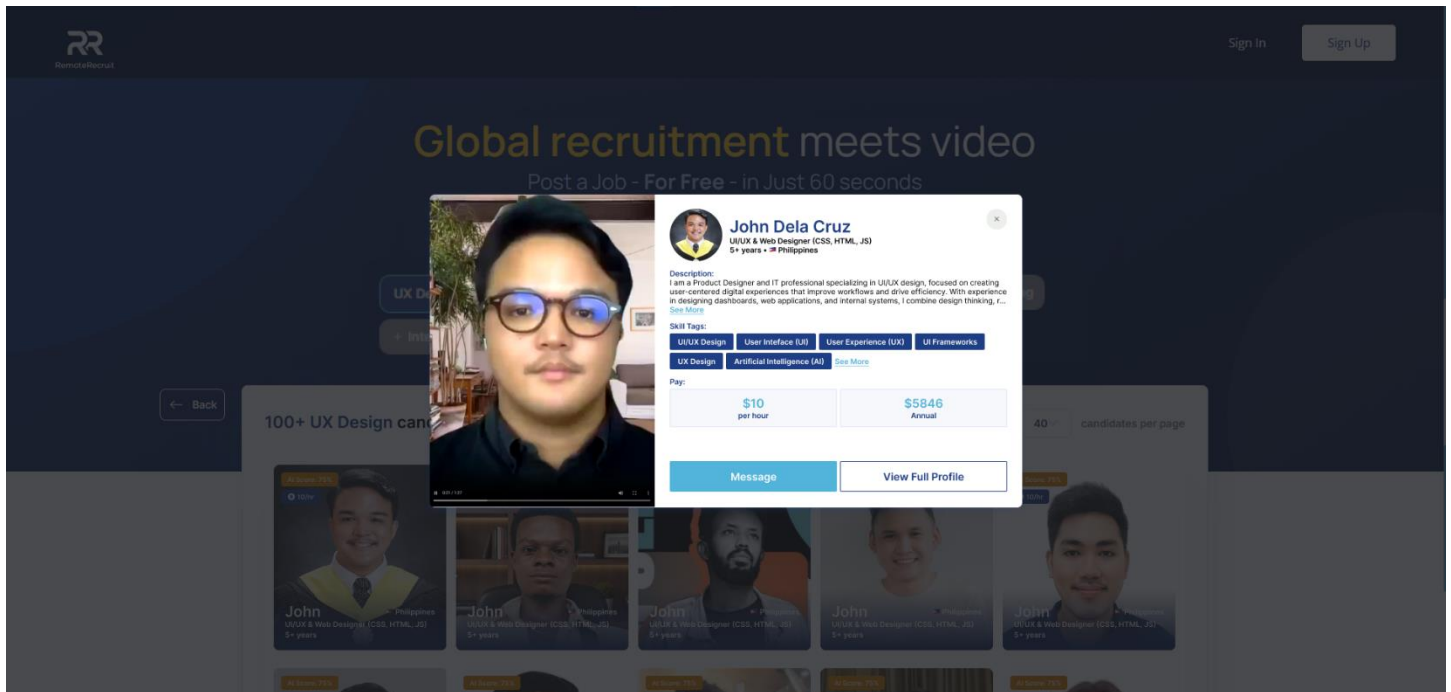
Key Notes:

While the primary focus of this redesign is the candidate card experience, an opportunity for future improvement exists in the search and filtering system. Introducing a more structured filter bar beneath the results summary (e.g., total candidates found and pagination controls) could improve discoverability and allow employers to refine candidate pools more efficiently.



Candidate Profile Preview Modal Redesign

Split layout: video resume on the left, candidate details (name, role, tags, rate, bio, CTAs) on the right.



Problem	Changes	Reason
Candidate card photo is heavily dimmed with a play video button	Moved the candidate photo to the top section	Preserve visibility of the candidate's face and improve visual hierarchy
Video resume requires clicking a play button and opens a separate video player modal	Embedded the video player within the split layout	Reduce friction by removing an extra interaction step to view the video resume
No visible years of experience	Updated layout to display Name, Country, Role, and Years of Experience	Surface key candidate information without requiring navigation to the full profile
Inconsistent padding and widths	Standardized padding and ensured consistent layout widths across modal elements	Improve visual balance and alignment
Poor text contrast using gray font color	Updated typography to use darker text colors and a consistent font hierarchy	Improve readability, contrast, and information hierarchy
"Show More" button opens the full profile page	"Show More" now expands full description and skill tags within the preview modal	Reduce unnecessary navigation since a separate "View Full Profile" action already exists
Close button too large	Reduced close button size	Improve visual proportion and reduce UI dominance